



Innovative English Olympiad

Model Paper 2025 – 2026

Total Questions: 50

Time: 1.5 hr.

Total Marks: 100

Syllabus

Vocabulary and Functional Grammar: Parts of speech and their correct usage in the sentences, articles, tenses, punctuations, jumbled words, syllables, and word formation; vocabulary development; analogies; synonyms and antonyms; determiners, quantifiers, collocations; phrasal verbs; clauses and phrases; sentence structure; subject-verb agreement; identifying the odd-one-out; one-word substitutes; idiomatic expressions; direct and indirect speech; active and passive voice; etc.

Reading Comprehension: Understanding the story holistically and interpreting information in detail; comprehending phrases, phrasal verbs, and idioms both contextually and independently; analysing specific details and their implications; extracting information about events, characters, and references within the text; identifying underlying messages and moral perspectives; and related comprehension skills.

Interactive English: Formal written communication; expressing surprises, etiquette in personal and telephonic conversations; appropriate expressions; seeking permission; introducing oneself; ability to understand situation-based variations, conveying information clearly; giving advice; consoling; warning; engaging in arguments; and expressing polite disagreement.

Instructions:

1. This question paper contains 50 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The duration of the examination is 90 minutes.
3. Each question carries 2 marks. There is no negative marks for wrong answers.
4. Use only blue or black ball-point pen to mark your answers on the OMR Answer Sheet.
5. The use of calculators, mobile phones, smart watches, log tables, or any electronic gadgets is strictly prohibited.

English

1. Choose the word that best fits the sentence:
The committee rejected the proposal as it lacked _____ and long-term vision.
- | | |
|---------------|----------------|
| (A) coherence | (B) redundancy |
| (C) fragility | (D) obscurity |

2. Choose the correct synonym of **INCESSANT**:
- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (A) Occasional | (B) Continuous |
| (C) Dormant | (D) Sporadic |

3. Choose the correct antonym of **PLAUSIBLE**:
 (A) Logical (B) Convincing
 (C) Improbable (D) Reasonable
4. Choose the correct one-word substitute:
 A person who speaks many languages
 (A) Linguist (B) Polyglot
 (C) Philologist (D) Orator
5. Identify the correctly spelled word meaning "capable of being understood":
 (A) Comprehensable
 (B) Comprehensible
 (C) Comprehendable
 (D) Comprehesible
6. She has been working on this project _____ three months without a break.
 (A) since (B) for
 (C) from (D) during
7. Neither the teacher nor the students _____ aware of the schedule change.
 (A) was (B) were
 (C) has been (D) is
8. Choose the correct sentence:
 (A) He suggested me to apply early.
 (B) He suggested that I apply early.
 (C) He suggested I to apply early.
 (D) He suggested me applying early.
9. If she _____ harder, she would have secured the scholarship.
 (A) works (B) worked
 (C) had worked (D) would work
10. The letter _____ by the manager before it was dispatched.
 (A) is signed (B) was signed
 (C) had been signed (D) has signed
11. The negotiations finally _____ due to lack of mutual trust.
 (A) broke down (B) broke in
 (C) broke out (D) broke off
12. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom "spill the beans":
 (A) Waste food
 (B) Reveal a secret
 (C) Lose patience
 (D) Make a mistake
13. The child refused to _____ the rules imposed by the school.
 (A) put up with (B) run into
 (C) fall apart (D) bring about
14. Choose the correct collocation:
 (A) Heavy rain (B) Strong rain
 (C) Big rain (D) Hard rain
15. Identify the part of the sentence that has an error:
 She insisted that he *goes* to the doctor immediately.
 (A) She insisted (B) that he goes
 (C) to the doctor (D) immediately
16. Identify the grammatically correct sentence:
 (A) The information are confidential.
 (B) The informations is confidential.
 (C) The information is confidential.
 (D) The informations are confidential.
17. Choose the sentence with correct punctuation:
 (A) However she refused to accept the offer.
 (B) However, she refused to accept the offer.
 (C) However she, refused to accept the offer.
 (D) However; she refused to accept the offer.

18. Identify the type of clause underlined:

I know that he will succeed.

- (A) Adjective clause
- (B) Adverb clause
- (C) Noun clause
- (D) Relative clause

19. Rearrange the following to form a meaningful sentence:

- 1) despite 2) Continued
- 3) difficulties 4) she
- 5) The project

- (A) 4-2-5-1-3 (B) 4-2-1-3-5
- (C) 4-1-3-2-5 (D) 4-2-5-3-1

20. Choose the sentence with correct subject–verb agreement:

- (A) A bouquet of flowers were placed on the table.
- (B) A bouquet of flowers was placed on the table.
- (C) A bouquet of flower were placed on the table.
- (D) A bouquet were placed on the table.

21. Choose the odd one out:

- (A) Benevolent (B) Kind
- (C) Compassionate (D) Hostile

22. Choose the correct analogy:

Teacher : School :: Doctor : ?

- (A) Clinic (B) Hospital
- (C) Patient (D) Medicine

23. Identify the correct determiner:

There are _____ students who can solve this problem easily.

- (A) little (B) much
- (C) few (D) less

24. Choose the correct form of the verb:

By the time we arrived, the show ____.

- (A) started (B) has started
- (C) had started (D) starts

25. Convert into indirect speech:

He said, "I am preparing for the examination."

- (A) He said that he prepared for the examination.
- (B) He said that he was preparing for the examination.
- (C) He said that he prepares for the examination.
- (D) He said that he had been preparing for the examination.

26. Identify the sentence in passive voice:

- (A) They completed the assignment.
- (B) The assignment was completed by them.
- (C) They have completed the assignment.
- (D) They are completing the assignment.

27. Choose the correct quantifier:

There isn't _____ information available about the incident.

- (A) many (B) few
- (C) much (D) several

28. Choose the correct idiomatic expression:

He accepted the challenge _____.

- (A) by heart
- (B) in good faith
- (C) at random
- (D) under the weather

29. Choose the correct word formation:

The judge appreciated her _____ honesty.

- (A) absolute (B) absolutely
- (C) absolution (D) absolved

30. Choose the correct sentence:

- (A) He is capable to solve this issue.
- (B) He is capable of solving this issue.
- (C) He is capable solving this issue.
- (D) He is capable solve this issue.

- 31.** You want to politely refuse an invitation due to prior commitments. What should you say?
- (A) I can't come.
(B) I'm busy.
(C) I'd love to, but I already have a prior commitment.
(D) That's not possible.
- 32.** Choose the most appropriate response: "I'm extremely sorry for the inconvenience caused."
- (A) That's unacceptable.
(B) It doesn't matter.
(C) Thank you for informing me.
(D) Why did this happen?
- 33.** Select the sentence suitable for a formal telephone conversation:
- (A) Hey, what's up?
(B) Could you please connect me to the accounts department?
(C) Put me through fast.
(D) Who's speaking?
- 34.** Choose the best expression for giving advice:
- (A) You must do this.
(B) Why didn't you do this?
(C) You might consider doing this.
(D) Do it immediately.
- 35.** Choose the polite way to disagree:
- (A) You're completely wrong.
(B) That's nonsense.
(C) I see your point, but I have a different perspective.
(D) You don't understand this.

Passage : The Silent Strength of Discipline

Discipline is often misunderstood as a rigid system of restrictions, but in reality, it is the

foundation of personal freedom. Individuals who cultivate discipline are not confined by rules; instead, they gain control over their impulses and choices. A disciplined student, for instance, does not study merely out of fear of failure but because learning has become a habit rather than a burden.

In competitive environments, discipline distinguishes consistency from momentary brilliance. Talent may open doors, but discipline ensures that one walks through them repeatedly. Athletes, artists, and scholars alike rely on structured routines that enable gradual improvement. These routines may appear monotonous to outsiders, yet they provide stability and direction.

Moreover, discipline nurtures resilience. When motivation fades—as it inevitably does—discipline sustains effort. It trains the mind to persist even when external rewards are absent. Thus, discipline is not the enemy of creativity or happiness; rather, it silently supports both, allowing individuals to achieve long-term success without constant struggle.

- 36.** According to the passage, discipline primarily helps individuals to
- (A) follow strict external rules
(B) avoid competition
(C) control their impulses and choices
(D) reduce responsibilities
- 37.** The phrase "momentary brilliance" refers to
- (A) lifelong achievement
(B) short-lived success
(C) creative thinking
(D) academic excellence

38. Why do routines appear monotonous to outsiders?
- (A) They lack creativity
 - (B) They involve repetition
 - (C) They reduce freedom
 - (D) They discourage growth
39. What role does discipline play when motivation fades?
- (A) It replaces ambition
 - (B) It eliminates challenges
 - (C) It sustains continued effort
 - (D) It ensures immediate rewards
40. The tone of the passage can best be described as
- (A) Critical
 - (B) Reflective and encouraging
 - (C) Humorous
 - (D) Argumentative

Passage: Technology and the Illusion of Connectivity

Modern technology has transformed the way people communicate, creating an illusion of constant connectivity. Messages travel across continents in seconds, and social media platforms allow individuals to share moments of their lives instantly. Yet, despite this unprecedented access, meaningful communication has become increasingly fragile.

Digital conversations often lack emotional depth. Facial expressions, tone, and pauses—essential elements of human interaction—are frequently lost behind screens. As a result, misunderstandings arise more easily, and empathy is diluted. People may appear socially active online while remaining emotionally isolated in reality.

Furthermore, the constant stream of notifications fragments attention. Conversations are interrupted, listening becomes superficial, and reflection is replaced by rapid responses. Technology itself is not the adversary; rather, unmindful usage creates distance instead of connection. True communication, therefore, requires conscious effort, even in a digitally connected world.

41. The “illusion of connectivity” refers to
- (A) advanced digital tools
 - (B) faster communication
 - (C) superficial social interaction
 - (D) global communication networks
42. Which element of communication is often missing in digital conversations?
- (A) Vocabulary
 - (B) Accuracy
 - (C) Emotional cues
 - (D) Information
43. What is the main cause of misunderstanding in online communication?
- (A) Poor grammar
 - (B) Lack of technology
 - (C) Absence of human expressions
 - (D) Language barriers
44. According to the passage, technology becomes problematic when
- (A) it replaces education
 - (B) it is used excessively and without awareness
 - (C) it connects people globally
 - (D) it evolves rapidly
45. The author suggests that true communication requires
- (A) advanced devices
 - (B) frequent messaging
 - (C) conscious and mindful effort
 - (D) social media platforms

Passage: Failure as a Teacher

Failure is often viewed as a permanent mark of inadequacy, especially in academic and competitive settings. Students fear mistakes because they associate them with judgment and disappointment. However, failure, when approached constructively, can become one of the most effective teachers.

Each failure carries information—about what strategies were ineffective, where understanding was incomplete, or how preparation fell short. Those who analyse their failures gain clarity and direction. Instead of repeating errors, they refine their methods and strengthen their skills. In contrast, avoiding failure altogether often results in stagnation and complacency.

History repeatedly demonstrates that success is rarely linear. Many innovators and leaders encountered repeated setbacks before achieving recognition. Their resilience lay not in avoiding failure, but in learning from it. Thus, failure should be reframed not as an endpoint, but as a necessary stage in the journey of growth.

46. Why do students generally fear failure, according to the passage?

- (A) It delays success
- (B) It involves extra effort
- (C) It is associated with judgment
- (D) It is unavoidable

47. What does each failure provide, as mentioned in the passage?

- (A) Motivation
- (B) Information and insight
- (C) Confidence
- (D) Recognition

48. The word “*stagnation*” in the passage most nearly means

- (A) rapid progress
- (B) confusion
- (C) lack of growth
- (D) exhaustion

49. What common pattern is observed in the lives of successful people?

- (A) They achieved success early
- (B) They avoided competition
- (C) They experienced repeated setbacks
- (D) They relied on talent alone

50. The central message of the passage is that failure

- (A) should be feared
- (B) is unavoidable
- (C) marks the end of effort
- (D) contributes to growth when learned from.

KEY

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|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| 1) A | 2) B | 3) C | 4) B | 5) B | 6) B | 7) B |
| 8) B | 9) C | 10) C | 11) A | 12) B | 13) A | 14) A |
| 15) B | 16) C | 17) B | 18) C | 19) A | 20) B | 21) D |
| 22) B | 23) C | 24) C | 25) B | 26) B | 27) C | 28) B |
| 29) A | 30) B | 31) C | 32) B | 33) B | 34) C | 35) C |
| 36) C | 37) B | 38) B | 39) C | 40) B | 41) C | 42) C |
| 43) C | 44) B | 45) C | 46) C | 47) B | 48) C | 49) C |
| 50) D | | | | | | |